

Design Explanation – My Academic Portfolio Website

Project Overview

This website was developed as part of the Web Development course to represent my academic identity as a Computer Science student. The project consists of three main pages: Home, Profile, and Contact. The overall design focuses on clarity, simplicity, and expressing my personal interests in calm places, the sea, and minimalistic aesthetics.

Visual Style and Color Choices

The color palette is based on light blue tones to create a calm and peaceful atmosphere. Blue is associated with trust, clarity, and the sea, which reflects my personal connection to quiet environments and nature. The design follows a minimalist approach to keep the interface clean, readable, and beginner-friendly.

Page Structure and Layout

Semantic HTML elements were used throughout the website to ensure proper structure and accessibility. These include `<header>`, `<nav>`, `<main>`, `<section>`, and `<footer>`.

- The **Home page** uses CSS Grid to place the image placeholder and introduction text side by side.
- The **Profile page** organizes personal information, education, skills, and hobbies into clearly separated sections.
- The **Contact page** presents my academic email in a simple and direct layout.

Flexbox was used for navigation alignment and for responsive behavior across different screen sizes.

Wireframe Planning

Before writing the code, I created hand-drawn wireframes for all three pages. These sketches helped me plan the layout, spacing, and content hierarchy. Each wireframe includes the main structural components of the page without detailed styling, which is appropriate for the planning stage.

Content Decisions

The content was selected to reflect both my academic background and my personality. I used a symbolic image placeholder instead of a personal photo to maintain privacy. The introduction text highlights my interests in the sea, sunsets, and peaceful places. The Profile page presents my academic journey and skills in a structured way, while the Contact page provides my official college email.

Accessibility Considerations

Accessibility was an important part of the design process. Several practices were applied to make the website more inclusive:

- High contrast between text and background for better readability.
- Clear typography with appropriate font sizes.
- Semantic HTML to support screen readers.
- Alternative text for images (if added in the future).
- Responsive layout using Flexbox and Grid to ensure usability on mobile and desktop devices.

These considerations improve the user experience for a wider range of visitors.

Conclusion

The final website combines a calm visual identity with organized content and modern web development practices. Through semantic HTML, CSS Grid, Flexbox, and hand-drawn wireframes, the project demonstrates both the design process and the technical implementation. The result is a simple, expressive, and functional academic portfolio that reflects my personality and goals as a Computer Science student.